MONTHLY UPDATE

Congo: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.

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INCLUSION
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Governance

Legislation and regulation

LAW NO. 8-2001 ON FREEDOM OF INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION

- **Sicom 2026 : nécessité de faire progresser le cadre juridique des médias au Congo** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville, 17 September 2026

  Opening the first Sicom media fair in Brazzaville on 17 September 2026, the Republic of Congo's prime minister, Anatole Collinet Makosso, said the 2001 law on freedom of information and communication must be updated for social networks, disinformation and artificial intelligence. No draft bill or timetable was announced.

- **Sicom 2026 : un bilan et des engagements pour l'avenir** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville, 21 September 2026

  Congo's first information, communication and media fair closed at Kintélé on 19 September 2026 with 23 resolutions from participants. They call for rewriting the three core media laws to take account of digital broadcasting, online platforms and AI, and cover digital content, advertising and tax. These are recommendations from the profession, not government decisions.

FINANCE LAW 2026, ARTICLE 13: REGISTRATION AND DECLARATION OF MONEY TRANSFERS

- **Congo/Finances : Jean Claude Bazebi déterminé à assurer la transparence dans le secteur des transferts de fonds** — Agence Congolaise d'information (ACI), 7 October 2026

The Republic of the Congo's money transfer regulator, ARTF, said on 5 October 2026 it will enforce article 13 of the 2026 finance law, which requires every money transfer operator to register on its digital platform and declare all transfers. Operators refusing to connect face a fine of 20 million FCFA. Electronic terminals will go first to Brazzaville and Pointe-Noire.

- **Transfert de fonds : l'usage des terminaux de paiement électronique entrera en vigueur dès janvier 2027** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville (ADIAC), 8 October 2026

  Congo's money-transfer regulator ARTF will require every money-transfer operator to use electronic payment terminals from January 2027, as the finance law provides, Les Dépêches de Brazzaville reported on 8 October 2026. The terminals record each transaction in real time for tax purposes; 200 of 1,000 ordered were shown to about a hundred transfer and exchange operators in Brazzaville.

Regional collaboration

BRAZZAVILLE DECLARATION ON CONGO-DRC CROSS-BORDER MOBILITY

- **Congo-RDC : mobilite transfrontaliere, Brazzaville jette les bases d'un nouvel espace commun** — Groupe Congo Medias, 10 September 2026 DRC

  A workshop in Brazzaville from 8 September 2026, run by the association Avenir NEPAD Congo with funding from the Konrad Adenauer Foundation, examined movement and trade between the Republic of Congo and the DRC, which share a border of about 2,400km. It closed with a 'Brazzaville Declaration' proposing measures to ease crossings, secure the border and increase trade.

REGIONAL FRAMEWORK FOR NATIONAL EMERGENCY TELECOMMUNICATIONS PLANS

- **Télécoms : l'Afrique centrale renforce ses dispositifs face aux catastrophes naturelles** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville, 15 September 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

  A regional workshop in Brazzaville on 15 and 16 September worked towards a common framework for national emergency telecommunications plans across central Africa, convened by the international telecommunications union with the regional regulators' assembly and the economic community.

Finance

New investments

NATIONAL DATA CENTRE FINANCING

- **Congo/Infrastructures : le data center opérationnel d'ici fin 2026** — Agence Congolaise d'Information, 24 September 2026

  The Republic of Congo's vice-prime minister, Jean-Jacques Bouya, said on 22 September 2026 that the African Development Bank-funded national data centre at Bacongo, Brazzaville, will be operational by the end of 2026, with works at 82%. He inspected it with digital minister Frédéric Nzé alongside the 12 MW Kintélé solar farm meant to back its power supply.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

UNIVERSAL ACCESS AND SERVICE FUND

- **Le Congo et l'Afrique centrale s'organisent pour mieux résister aux catastrophes** — La Brève Online, 15 September 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

> Experts from eight Central African countries met in Brazzaville on 15–17 September 2026 to review a model national emergency telecommunications plan for keeping communications running in disasters. Figures presented there credit Congo's universal service fund FASUCE with connecting more than 380,000 people in isolated areas and over 250 localities.

Data Storage

> NATIONAL DATA CENTRE

- **Congo/Infrastructures : le data center opérationnel d'ici fin 2026** — Agence Congolaise d'Information, 24 September 2026

  Summarised under New investments.

- **Le Vice-Premier ministre inspecte l'état d'avancement de la ferme solaire et du Data center** — Vox Congo, 24 September 2026

  The Republic of Congo's deputy prime minister, Jean-Jacques Bouya, and the telecoms and digital economy minister, Frédéric Nzé, inspected the national data centre at Bacongo, Brazzaville, and the Kintélé solar farm on 22 September 2026. Bouya said the data centre, built with the African Development Bank, should be operational by the end of 2026 or early 2027, after energy tests and then two to three months of data-centre tests.

DPI

Data Exchange

> NATIONAL DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE ARCHITECTURE

- **Architecture et Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)** — Ministère des Postes, des Télécommunications et de l'Économie numérique (MPTEN), République du Congo, 2 September 2026

  The Republic of Congo's digital economy ministry set out a national digital public infrastructure architecture built on MOSIP for digital identity, X-Road for data exchange between ministries, and Mojaloop for a payments switch linking MTN MoMo, Airtel Money, banks and the Treasury. Services would run through an e-Citizen portal hosted at the national data centre. The page describes plans; no adopting decree, cost or timetable is given.

Digital Payments and Fintech

> YANO PAYMENT AGGREGATION PLATFORM

- **Fintech : Yano se positionne dans la structuration des transactions financières mobiles** — Agence Congolaise d'Information, 29 September 2026

  Yano, a Congolese fintech launched on 14 September 2026, lets groups, traders and individuals collect contributions and take mobile payments by QR code or link, regardless of mobile operator, its co-founder Elwin Gomo told the Congolese news agency. It holds no cash itself. It is backed by the Bantulab programme through a 655 million CFA franc investment vehicle.

Registries

> INTEGRATED CIVIL-STATUS SYSTEM

- **État civil au Congo-Brazzaville : fini le temps des actes « bricolés » !** — Les Echos du Congo-Brazzaville, 6 September 2026

Congo-Brazzaville's territorial administration issued a circular on 1 September 2026 tightening control of civil registration. It bars antedating records, altering identity, parentage or date of birth without a court decision, and issuing several records for one person, and requires agents to check each document against the original register. Agents involved in document fraud face administrative and judicial sanctions.

- **Digitalisation de l'état civil : l'administration du territoire réceptionne les documents techniques (SIFEC)** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville (ADIAC), 23 September 2026

  The Republic of Congo's information systems agency ACSI handed the interior ministry's territorial administration directorate, on 22 September 2026 in Kintélé, the technical documents for SIFEC, a civil registration software it designed and built. Next steps include an inventory, data centralisation, user training, finalising the civil-status law and deployment. No cost or deployment date is given.

Sectoral management information systems

CHILDREN FIRST SOFTWARE FOR CHILDREN IN CARE

- **Affaires sociales : BEB réaffirme son engagement en faveur de la protection de l'enfance** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville (ADIAC), 11 September 2026

  Congo's Minister of Social Affairs, Marie-France Lydie Hélène Pongault, met the US NGO Both Ends Believing in Brazzaville on 10 September 2026 about the Children First Software, a tool to monitor children in care institutions and help return them to their families. The NGO, a partner since 2023, said it would help build the platform, train ministry staff and supply equipment.

Inclusion

Access to services

IRREGULARITY REPORTING CHANNEL

- **KO FUNDA — Signaler une irrégularité** — Ministère du Contrôle d'État, de la Qualité du Service public et de la Lutte contre les Antivaleurs — République du Congo, 2 September 2026

  The Republic of Congo's Ministry of State Control runs KO FUNDA, an online portal where citizens can report corruption, embezzlement, favouritism, absent officials, poor public service and excessive delays. The ministry says reports are handled confidentially and each is examined before any decision. The page carries no publication date.

WOMEN IN DIGITAL PROGRAMMES

- **Promotion de la femme : des étudiantes formées aux métiers du numérique** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville (ADIAC), 12 September 2026

  Congo-Brazzaville's Women's Advisory Council signed a partnership on 11 September 2026 with Hoz Fablab, a Brazzaville technology training centre, to train selected women students in digital skills for six months. The scholarship programme centres on designing, building and hosting websites.

Data

National statistics

PERMANENT STATISTICAL SYSTEM FOR INFORMAL CROSS-BORDER TRADE

- **Commerce transfrontalier : l'INS cible l'informel** — Brazzavillois, 6 October 2026

> Congo's statistics institute held a workshop in Brazzaville on 2 October to set up a permanent statistical system for informal cross-border trade. A mapping of border crossings is under way, a baseline survey is planned for 2027 and quarterly collection is to feed the balance of payments, with World Bank support.

Use of satellite data

> NATIONAL POSITION ON SPACE TECHNOLOGIES
>
> - **Technologies spatiales : le Congo mise sur l'innovation pour accélérer son développement** — Les Depeches de Brazzaville, 10 September 2026
>
> Congo-Brazzaville presents space technologies as a strategic lever for development - forest observation, agriculture, telecommunications and scientific training - with a delegation led by the head of state at the international space summit in Paris. No agency, programme or budget is named.

> FIRST EARTH-OBSERVATION SATELLITE, WITH KAZAKHSTAN
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> - **Technologies spatiales : le Congo se prépare à lancer son premier satellite d'observation** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville (ADIAC), 12 September 2026
>
> Congo-Brazzaville and Kazakhstan are working to build and launch Congo's first Earth-observation satellite, Kazakh deputy prime minister Zhaslan Madiyev said after meeting President Denis Sassou N'Guesso in Paris, reported on 12 September 2026. The satellite is to monitor forests, farming, mining and flood-prone areas, and the talks also covered AI training for Congolese officials. No cost or launch date is given.

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